

Private thoughts

Researchers have built a device that allows you to 'think' your password and be granted access <http://dgit.in/120F9jh>

**Ooh the sun**

The Solar Dynamics Observatory has been sending pictures of the sun to us for three years. Have a look <http://dgit.in/17WaMet>

Your Dose of Paranoia

The present is becoming ever more perilous, with the potential for cyber-terrorism growing rapidly alongside global connectivity. From apps that can hijack and crash planes, to record-breaking DDoS attacks, these ominous portents are just the tip of the iceberg of paranoia

World's Biggest DDoS Attack

A massive DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service) attack levelled against Dutch anti-spam group Spamhaus may be causing global internet speeds to plummet. A BBC report states that the DDoS attack entailed Spamhaus' servers being assaulted by 300 Gb/s of data through a technique called DNS reflection. What was considered the largest DDoS attack before this comprised a peak data rate of 100 Gb/s. While speaking to the BBC, cybersecurity expert Alan Woodward said that this massive traffic was resulting in falling internet speeds across the world.



DDoS attacks are paralyzing

The DDoS attack against Spamhaus comes in the wake of the blacklisting of Cyberbunker, a Dutch web hosting service, by the anti-spamming group. Cyberbunker, whose unofficial motto is that it will host anything that's not child pornography or terrorism-related, has now been accused by Spamhaus of colluding with Eastern-European criminal gangs to wage the DDoS attack in retaliation. Cyberbunker has rejected the accusations and said that Stophaus, an

online group formed by ISPs and users disgruntled by Spamhaus are to be blamed. Cyberbunker also criticized Spamhaus for falsely accusing many ISPs of being spammers, and blacklisting them without evidence.

Read about other accusations by Cyberbunker against Spamhaus at <http://bit.ly/14xDpyR>

Security Analyst Develops Hijacking App for Android

A security analyst has revealed how simple it is to hack into the communication link-up between a plane and the air traffic control system, and the plane's navigation system in order to change the plane's route or even to crash it. Hugo Teso, an analyst with German IT security company N.Runs AG and a licensed commercial pilot, has developed an exploit framework called 'Simon' which is used by an Android app to deliver data that can instigate an attack against an airplane.

Teso revealed that he could exploit a plane's Automatic Dependant Surveillance-Broadcast (ADS-B) system, the system that transmits the plane's current navigation details to Air Traffic Controllers (ATC) and the Aircraft Communications Addressing and Reporting System (ACARS), a communication link between the plane and the ATC, to feed in false information and cause the plane to change course or get into an accident. Teso said that it took three years to develop the Simon



An app compromises Android

framework which uses information from Flightradar24, a free website that tracks flight paths in real-time, and publicly available Flight Management System hardware and software, both of which are very similar (but not exactly the same) as the ones used in the real world.

Fortunately, Teso's system can only be used virtually at present and a hijacker would only be able to remotely control a plane if it was within the antenna range of his hacking system. Also, if a pilot somehow was able to recognize the infiltration, he could take control of the plane manually, since Teso's system can only influence the plane when it's in autopilot mode. Teso stressed on how vulnerable the existing ACARS was and how a plane would have no way to determine if the data being transmitted through ACARS was valid. Teso says that he has been in touch with airlines to fix the vulnerabilities in the ADS-B system.

WordPress-based Websites Under Attack

A relatively low-key, but intense attack on WordPress (WP) based sites is under way.

Hackers are trying to access WP-based servers that are using common usernames and passwords such as 'Admin', 'adm', 'test', 'password', 'password1' etc. The attack seems to originate from a botnet comprising of close to, or just over, 90,000 PCs and seems to be an attempt to gain access to a pool of servers that can be used to launch attacks in the future.

The attack itself is a very basic brute-force attack that takes advantage of our laziness by trying to guess a server's password from a bunch of commonly used passwords. The attack is currently using comparatively underpowered home



Wordpress' shield blown away

PCs with limited bandwidth, but as it gains access to more and more servers, the attack can grow in magnitude.

To protect yourself on WordPress-based websites, change your username and password to a stronger one, turn on two-factor authentication and make sure you're up-to-date on the latest version of WordPress. CloudFare, a sort of online firewall, is also offering free protection for users that use its service to protect their sites. 